

GWOP UNIVERSITY

*They never taught us the game, so we built the school.*

THE FREE BLUEPRINT

# From Handcuffs to Credit Limits

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Why I built GWOP University — and what I had to learn the hard way.

School didn't teach us the game. So we built the school.

## **This Is Not Just Financial Literacy**

This is life literacy.

This is credit. This is funding. This is faith. This is fatherhood. This is rebuilding after losing years of your life. This is learning the game they never taught us, then coming back to teach everybody else.

My name is Beast.

Some people know me from Cottrell Vision. Some from Simple Strategy Consulting. Some from Handcuffs 2 Cufflinks. Some know me as the Funding Plug.

But before all of that, I was just a man trying to figure it out. A man who lost years. A man who had to rebuild from the ground up. A man who had to learn patience the hard way. A man who had to stop making excuses and start creating structure.

Now my mission is simple: I want everybody around me to eat.

But when I say everybody eats, I'm not talking about giving people money. I'm talking about giving people information that can change their life.

Because if I give you money, you may eat today. But if I teach you how credit works, how funding works, how banks think, how business structure works, how to build a fundable profile, and how to move with discipline — now you can eat for life.

That's the mission.

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## **What I Really Do**

I help people understand the system.

How to fix the foundation. How to build personal credit. How to clean up a profile. How to structure a business. How to create bank relationships. How to prepare for funding. How to use credit the right way. How to stop begging banks and start positioning yourself so banks want to do business with you.

Because the game is not just getting approved. The game is understanding *why* you got approved. Why you got denied. What banks are looking for before you even apply.

A lot of people are applying randomly. Hoping. Guessing. Praying the bank says yes.

I don't teach guessing. I teach structure.

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## **I Did Not Come From Easy**

I didn't come from a perfect situation. I didn't come from a silver spoon.

I came from struggle. From mistakes. From pain. From being counted out.

I came from prison.

I know what it feels like to have people judge you by your worst chapter. I know what it feels like to come home and have to rebuild your name, your credit, your confidence, your money, your relationships, your business, and your mind.

I know what it feels like to want more but not know where to start. I know what it feels like to be surrounded by people who are surviving, so survival starts to feel normal.

That's why I talk the way I talk. I'm not teaching this from a textbook. I'm teaching it from experience.

I had to learn that money is not just about hustling.

Money responds to structure. Banks respond to structure. Business responds to structure. Credit responds to structure.

Once I learned that, everything started changing.

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## **School Did Not Teach Us the Game**

They taught us how to work. They didn't teach us how banks think.

They taught us how to pay bills. They didn't teach us how to build leverage.

They taught us to use cash. They didn't teach us how wealthy people use credit.

They taught us to be scared of debt. They didn't teach us the difference between bad debt and strategic leverage.

They taught us how to survive. They didn't teach us how to become fundable.

That's why GWOP University exists.

**School didn't teach us the game. So we built the school.**

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## Why Credit Changed Everything for Me

When I really started understanding credit, I started seeing life differently.

A high credit score by itself is not enough. You can have a 750 or 800 and still get denied.

Why? Because banks aren't just looking at the number. They're looking at the profile — your history, your credit limits, your utilization, your payment behavior, your age of accounts, your inquiries, your relationships with other banks, your income, your business structure, your bank statements, your overall risk.

Don't just chase the score. Build the profile. The score gets attention. The profile gets respect.

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## Comparable Credit Matters

Here's something a lot of people don't understand.

If the biggest limit you ever had is \$500, don't be surprised when the next bank only gives you \$1,000.

**Banks look at what other banks trusted you with.**

If no major institution has trusted you with real limits yet, you may need to build your way up.

This is why I tell people to stop adding random credit products to their report and thinking they're building a powerful profile. Everything that reports is not equal. Some accounts make you look stronger. Some make you look like a beginner. Some make you look risky.

A credit profile is like a resume. If you're trying to get into the big leagues, your resume needs to show experience.

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## Secured Loans and Pledge Loans

People ask: "How do I build positive accounts if my credit is damaged?"

One strategy is a secured or pledge-style loan through a credit union. You place money into a savings or certificate account, then borrow against it. Because the loan is secured by your own funds, the risk to the institution is lower. Managed properly, it can help build positive payment history.

But let me be clear. You still need to understand the terms. You still need to make payments on time. You still need to know how it reports. You still need to use it as part of a bigger strategy.

This isn't magic. This is structure.

Look into shared secured loans, certificate secured loans, or pledge loans at credit unions. Ask questions. Understand the rules. Then use the product the right way.

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## **Authorized Users and Tradelines**

A lot of people sell them. A lot of people hype them up.

I'm going to keep it real. I don't want people depending on shortcuts.

Yes, being added as an authorized user may help in some situations. But underwriters aren't stupid. Banks can look deeper. They may see that you were just added. They may see there's no real payment behavior from you. They may see the account isn't really yours. They may not give it the same weight as a real primary account.

I'd rather teach you to build your own profile. Your own accounts. Your own history. Your own relationship with banks.

**When the profile belongs to you, the leverage belongs to you.**

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## **Stop Applying Randomly**

One of the biggest mistakes I see is people applying for credit with no strategy. Wrong bank, wrong product, wrong time, wrong profile. Then they get denied and blame the bank.

But the bank was never the problem. The strategy was the problem.

Every bank is different. Some are better for personal cards. Some for business cards. Some for lines of credit. Some for auto loans. Some for relationship banking. Some care more about inquiries. Some care more about utilization. Some care more about deposits. Some want documents. Some want business revenue.

You have to know where you're going and why.

Don't apply because somebody online got approved. Their profile isn't your profile. Their bank relationship isn't your bank relationship. Their timing isn't your timing.

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## Utilization: Stop Maxing Out Your Cards

Credit cards are not extra income. A credit limit is not a green light to spend the whole thing.

If you have a \$10,000 card and you run it to \$9,800, that makes you look risky. Banks don't like desperation. Banks like control.

A strong profile usually keeps utilization low. A good general target is under 10%.

**Use the card. Don't let the card use you.**

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## Business Credit Is Different, But It Is Not Free Money

A lot of people think business credit doesn't matter because some business cards don't report to personal credit.

That's dangerous thinking.

Just because it may not show on your personal report every month doesn't mean nobody is watching. Business lenders can look at business credit data. Bank statements. Your business profile. Internal records. How you handle existing relationships.

Don't think you can max everything out and disappear. That's not strategy. That's recklessness.

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## The Funding Mistake That Breaks People

The biggest mistake people make when they get funding is shiny object syndrome.

They get \$50,000 or \$100,000 and suddenly they want to do everything. Airbnb. Turo. Real estate. Trading. Clothing brand. Studio. Restaurant. Crypto. New car. Vacation. Helping everybody. Buying things they don't need.

Then the money is gone. The business didn't grow. The payments are due. Now they're stressed.

Before you touch the funding, create the plan. Set aside money for payments. Know your use of funds. Know what creates revenue and what's just a distraction. Know how long the 0% APR period lasts. Know when the payments hit. Know the exit strategy.

**Funding without a plan is a trap. Funding with a plan is fuel.**

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## **Do Not Lie on Applications**

Let me be very clear.

Do not lie on credit applications. Do not make up fake numbers. Do not put information you cannot stand behind.

There's a difference between projected revenue and lying. Between stated income and fraud. Between positioning your business properly and fabricating a whole story.

The goal is to work with institutions that fit where you are. If a bank requires tax returns and you don't have them, that may not be the bank for you right now. If a bank wants strong deposits and you don't have deposits, build the relationship first.

Don't force it. Audit the bank. Ask questions. Know the requirements. Then apply with strategy.

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## **Banks Do Their Homework**

A lot of people think banks only look at the application. Wrong.

Depending on the product and the amount, banks may look at your personal credit, your business credit, your bank statements, your business address, your industry, your website, your social media, your public records, your income consistency, your business activity, your risk level, your location, and your overall story.

Make sure your business looks real. Your numbers make sense. Your website is clean. Your address is professional. Your bank statements aren't messy. Your profile matches what you're saying.

When the paperwork, the profile, and the story don't line up, that creates problems.

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## **Faith, Family, and Money**

Now let me shift for a second. Because this is bigger than credit.

For me, faith had to become the foundation.

There was a time when I thought more money would fix everything. More money. More success. More approvals. More attention. More motion.

But you can get what you prayed for and still feel empty if your spirit isn't right. You can get money and still not have peace. You can win publicly and still be struggling privately.

I had to learn that money can't be my God. Money is a tool. God is the source.

If God gives you the ability to create wealth, you have to be a good steward of it. You don't worship the money. You use it with purpose. You help people. You build. You provide. You give. You stay grounded. You remember who gave you the ability in the first place.

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## **Presence Over Presents**

I'm a father. Being present matters to me — especially knowing what it feels like when parts of fatherhood are missing.

I don't want to become the type of man who builds everything for his family but is never there to enjoy them. That's not success to me.

If I have to choose between money and being present for my children, I'm choosing presence.

Your kids may forget the toy. They may forget the sneakers. They may forget the trip. But they remember if you were there. If you showed up. If you listened. If you made time. If you were in the room.

**Presence over presents. That's real wealth.**

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## **What Real Rich Looks Like**

Real rich isn't just cars, watches, credit limits, funding approvals, luxury hotels, or first class.

Real rich is walking in the house and your kids are happy to see you. Real rich is peace. Health. A family that loves you. Being able to help people without destroying yourself. Waking up with purpose. Knowing you're not just chasing money — you're building something that matters.

That's the part social media doesn't show.

Everybody shows the win. They don't show the cost. They show the money, not the loneliness. The cars, not the pressure. The luxury, not the emptiness.

Don't compare your life to somebody's highlight reel. Comparison will kill your focus.

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## **Stop Comparing Yourself to Fake Success**

You're comparing your real life to somebody else's edited image.

You don't know if they own it. If they rented it. If they're in debt. If they're happy. If they're pretending. What they sacrificed to look successful.

Run your race. Build your foundation. Stay in your lane. Take 30 days off from watching everybody else if you need to.

Sometimes you're not losing. You're just distracted.

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## **The Power of the Tongue**

What you speak over your life matters.

If you keep saying "I'm broke," you're training your mind to stay there. If you keep saying "I can't do it," you're giving yourself permission not to try. If you keep saying "nothing works for me," you're building a belief system around failure.

Speak different:

I am building. I am learning. I am becoming disciplined. I am becoming fundable. I am fixing my credit. I am creating structure. I am breaking cycles. I am becoming the person my family needs. I am not who I used to be.

The words come first. Then the habits have to match. You can't just speak it and sit still. You speak it, then you move like it's true.

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## **A Word to Men Who Are Not Present**

If you're a father and you're purposely not involved in your child's life, you're playing with one of the biggest blessings God gave you.

That child didn't ask to be here.

Your presence matters. Your voice matters. Your time matters. Your correction matters. Your love matters. Your example matters.

Don't let money, women, pride, lifestyle, street activity, or selfishness rob your child of a father.

You don't have to be perfect. But you do have to show up.

Generational wealth is not just money. It's presence. Guidance. Structure. Love. Example. Being there.

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## **Credit Repair Is Not a Scam — Bad Delivery Is the Problem**

Some people say the credit repair and funding industry is a scam. I don't agree with that as a blanket statement.

Credit repair isn't the scam. Funding isn't the scam. Financial literacy isn't the scam.

The problem is when people overpromise, underdeliver, and don't have the systems to fulfill. When people sell dreams with no structure. When people charge big money but don't educate. When people get somebody funded but never teach them how to use the funding. When people care more about taking a percentage than changing a life.

That's why I teach.

Services have their place. Some people want done-for-you. Some people need help. But my mission is bigger than that.

I want to teach people how to fish. Because if you learn the game, nobody can keep taxing you for information you should understand yourself.

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## **Why I Built GWOP University**

GWOP University was built because people need structure. Not hype. Not random tips. Not fake guru talk.

Structure.

We teach personal credit mastery. Business credit structure. Funding readiness. Bank relationships. Credit card strategy. Travel benefits. Use-of-funds planning. Business setup. Money discipline. Mindset. Faith. Execution.

Because if you only teach people how to get money but not how to think, they may lose the money. If you only teach people how to apply but not how to prepare, they may get denied. If you only teach people how to fix credit but not how to fix habits, the damage comes back.

This is bigger than credit. This is transformation.

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## **To the Person Reading This**

If you feel stuck, I want you to hear me.

Start where you are.

Don't be ashamed of your starting point. Don't be embarrassed by your report. Don't be embarrassed by your past. Don't be embarrassed by what you don't know.

Nobody comes into the world knowing credit. Nobody comes into the world knowing funding. Nobody comes into the world knowing how banks underwrite.

You learn it. Then you apply it. Then you grow.

But you have to stop making excuses. Stop comparing. Stop waiting. Stop thinking somebody is coming to save you.

God can give you the ability, but you still have to move your feet. You still have to study. You still have to build. You still have to become disciplined. You still have to create structure. You still have to take action.

That's how your life changes.

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## **Where to Start**

If you want to learn how to build your credit profile, structure your business, understand bank relationships, prepare for funding, and use credit with discipline — this is what GWOP University is for.

This isn't just a course. This is for the person who's tired of being denied. Tired of being confused. Tired of watching everybody else get access. Tired of not knowing what to do next.

I built this for the people who were never taught the game.

Because once you learn the game, you stop begging for seats at tables. You start building your own.

Fix the foundation. Build the profile. Create the structure. Get the funding. Use it with wisdom. Feed your family. Help your people. Leave something behind.

That's the mission. That's the lifestyle. That's the GWOP way.

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*Educational material only. Not legal, financial, tax, or credit-repair advice. No outcome is guaranteed.*